

U.S. House of Representatives

Looking at the impact of a Freshman Member's office pull in the office lottery and their office location on the effectiveness in their first congress.

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Follow Along on Github
Web Archive (Wayback Machine) to access

An ornate, multi-armed chandelier hangs from the ceiling, casting light downwards. The background features classical architectural elements, including decorative moldings and a large, arched opening, possibly a doorway or a large window, framed by heavy columns. The overall atmosphere is formal and grand.

Where did the data come from?

Web Archive (Wayback Machine) to access
www.house.gov/representatives information across time

Center for Effective Lawmaking
(UVA & Vanderbilt)

Possibly soon the Architect of Capitol & House Committee on
Administration



Center for Effective Lawmaking

University of Virginia and Vanderbilt University

thelawmakers.org

LES

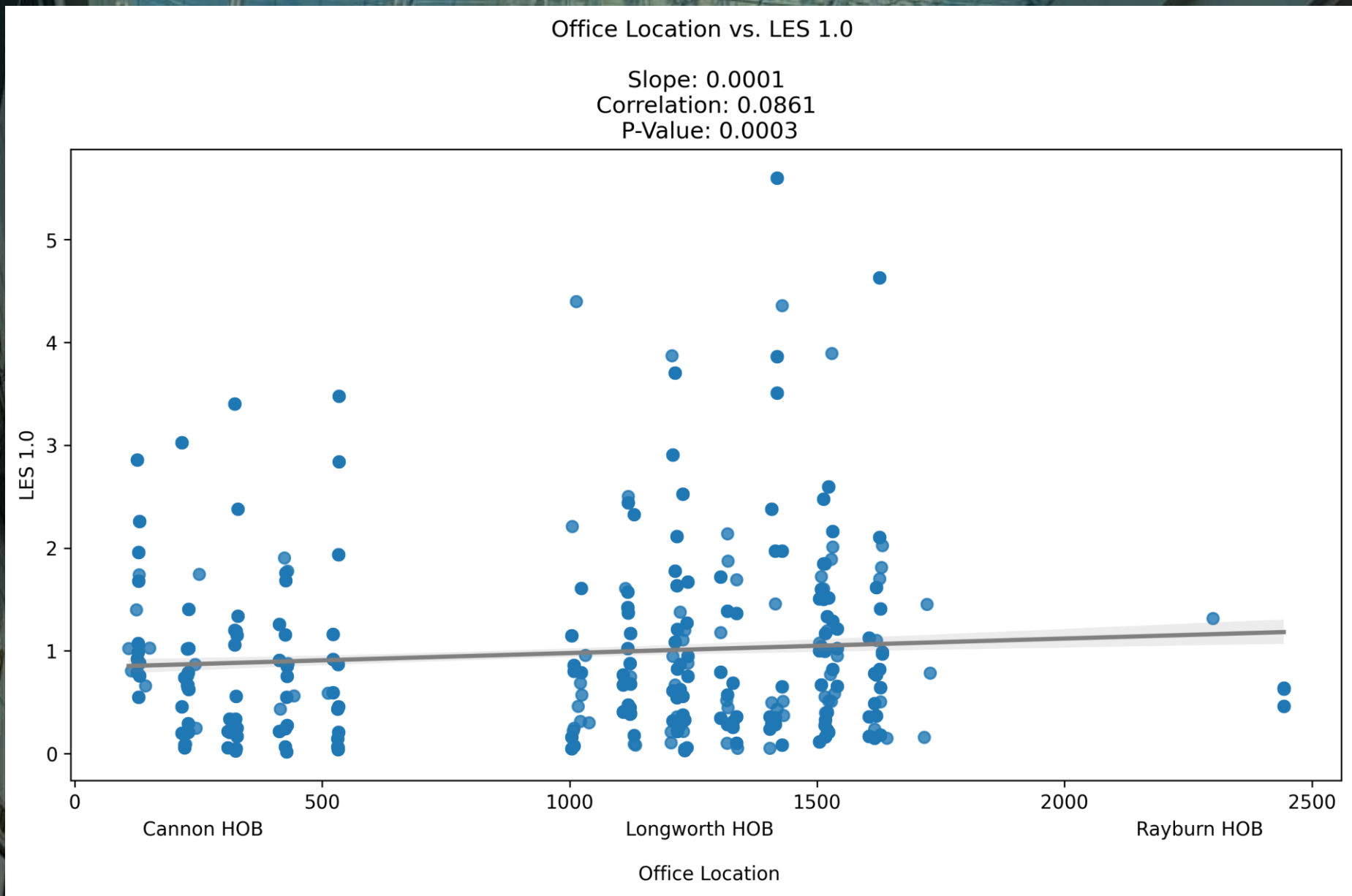
A summary measure that captures how successful a member of the House or Senate is at moving her agenda items. The average LES is 1.

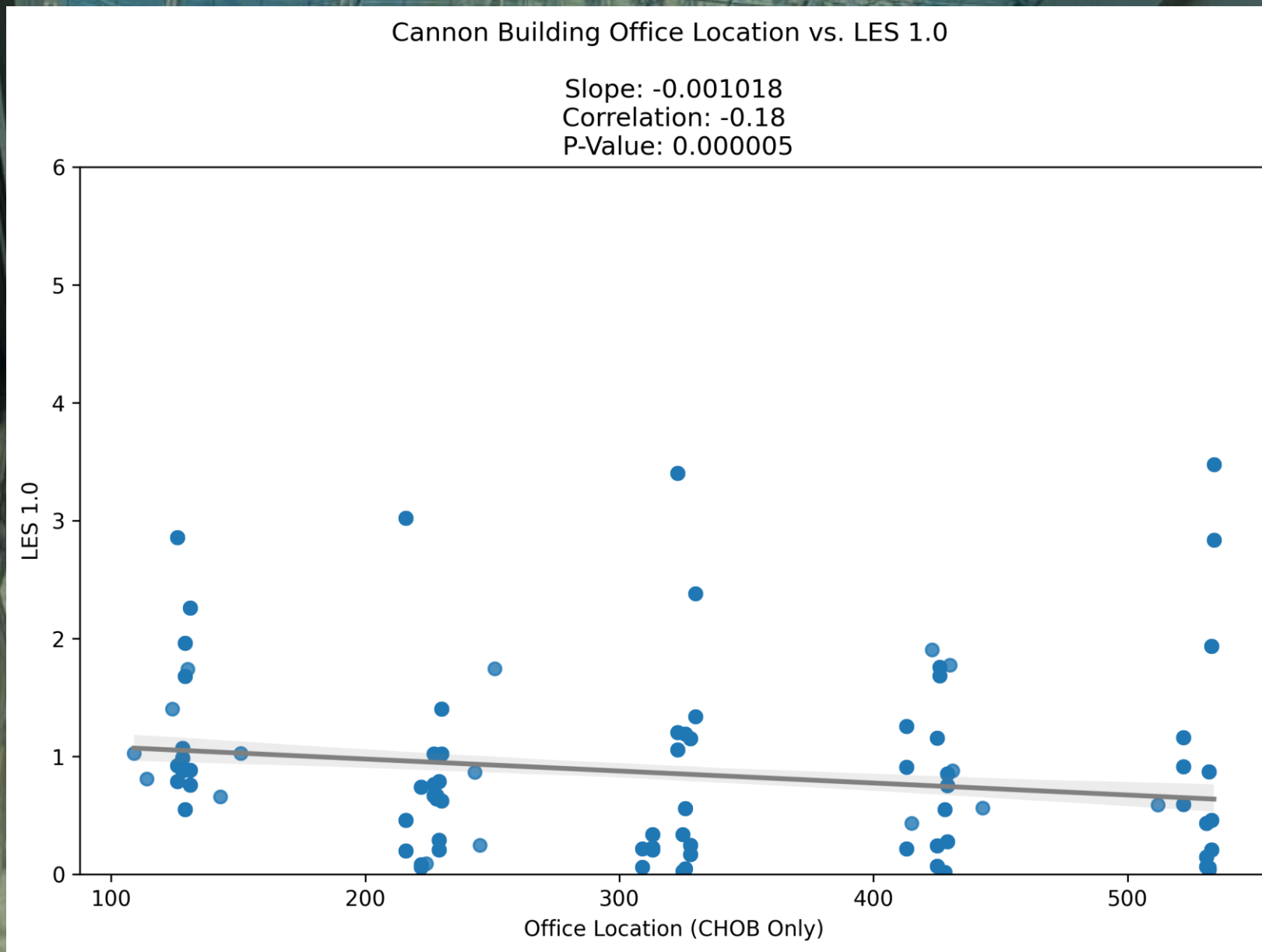
$$LES_{it} = \left[\begin{aligned} & \left(\frac{\alpha BILL_{it}^C + \beta BILL_{it}^S + \gamma BILL_{it}^{SS}}{\alpha \sum_{j=1}^N BILL_{jt}^C + \beta \sum_{j=1}^N BILL_{jt}^S + \gamma \sum_{j=1}^N BILL_{jt}^{SS}} \right) \\ & + \left(\frac{\alpha AIC_{it}^C + \beta AIC_{it}^S + \gamma AIC_{it}^{SS}}{\alpha \sum_{j=1}^N AIC_{jt}^C + \beta \sum_{j=1}^N AIC_{jt}^S + \gamma \sum_{j=1}^N AIC_{jt}^{SS}} \right) \\ & + \left(\frac{\alpha ABC_{it}^C + \beta ABC_{it}^S + \gamma ABC_{it}^{SS}}{\alpha \sum_{j=1}^N ABC_{jt}^C + \beta \sum_{j=1}^N ABC_{jt}^S + \gamma \sum_{j=1}^N ABC_{jt}^{SS}} \right) \\ & + \left(\frac{\alpha PASS_{it}^C + \beta PASS_{it}^S + \gamma PASS_{it}^{SS}}{\alpha \sum_{j=1}^N PASS_{jt}^C + \beta \sum_{j=1}^N PASS_{jt}^S + \gamma \sum_{j=1}^N PASS_{jt}^{SS}} \right) \\ & + \left(\frac{\alpha LAW_{it}^C + \beta LAW_{it}^S + \gamma LAW_{it}^{SS}}{\alpha \sum_{j=1}^N LAW_{jt}^C + \beta \sum_{j=1}^N LAW_{jt}^S + \gamma \sum_{j=1}^N LAW_{jt}^{SS}} \right) \end{aligned} \right] \left[\frac{N}{5} \right],$$

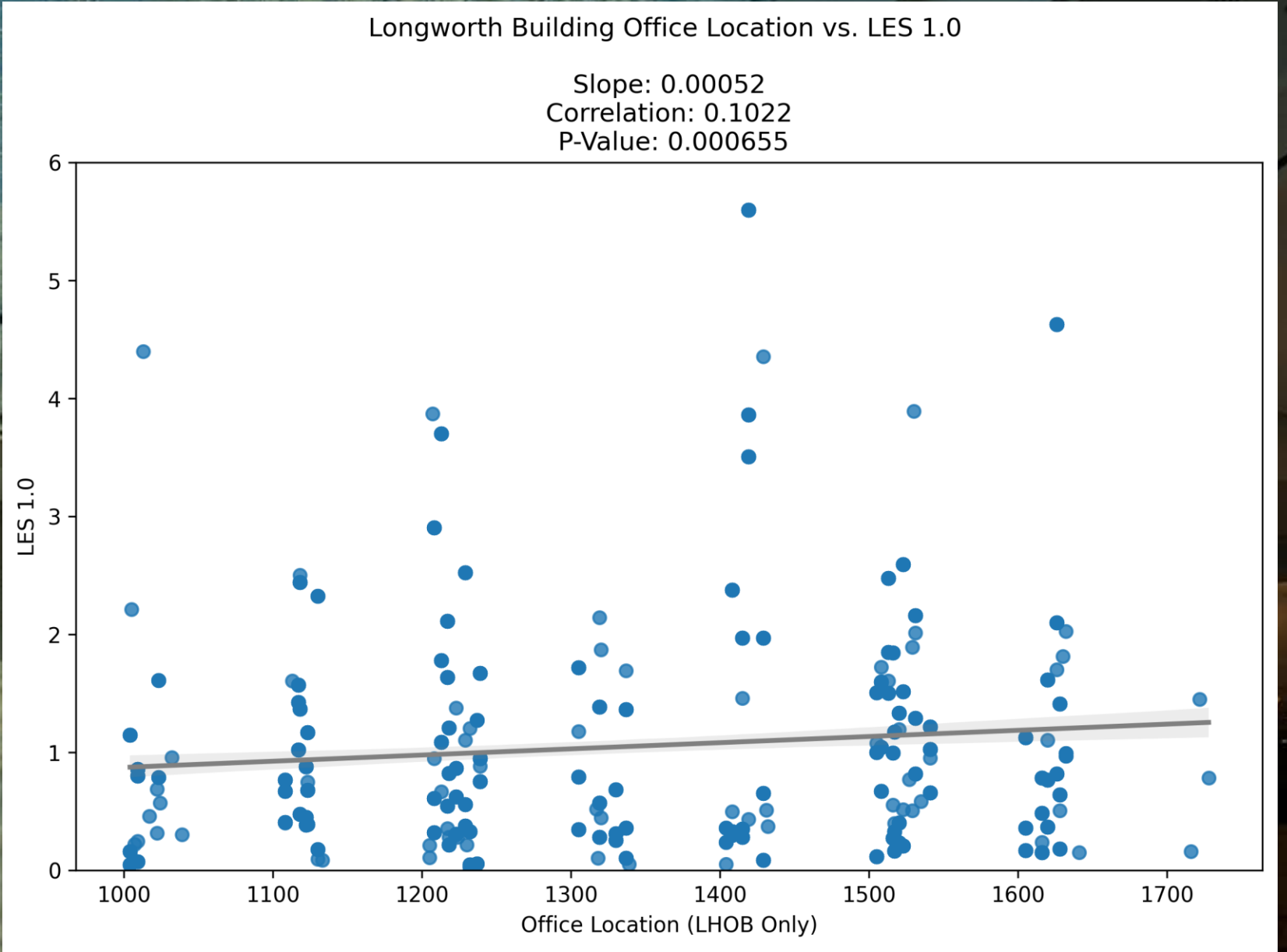
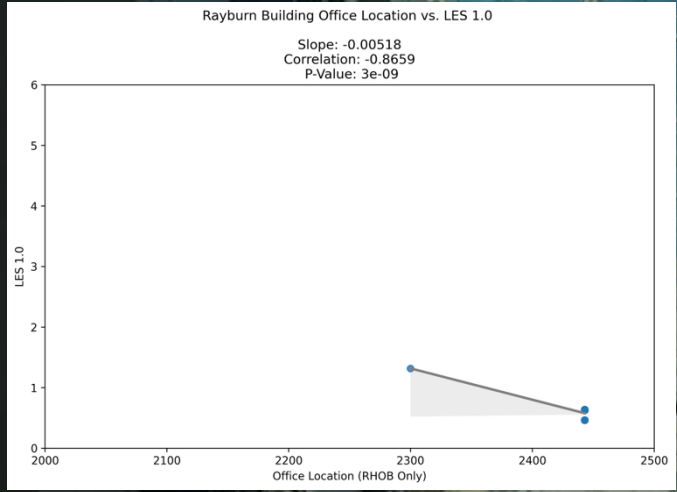
Benchmark

The expected LES of a member of the House or Senate given her party, tenure, and committee assignments.

$$\widehat{LES}_{it} = \hat{\alpha} + \hat{\beta}_{seniority} Seniority_{it} + \hat{\beta}_{majority} Majority_{it} + \hat{\beta}_{com_chair} Com_Chair_{it} + \hat{\beta}_{subcom_chair} Subcom_Chair_{it}$$

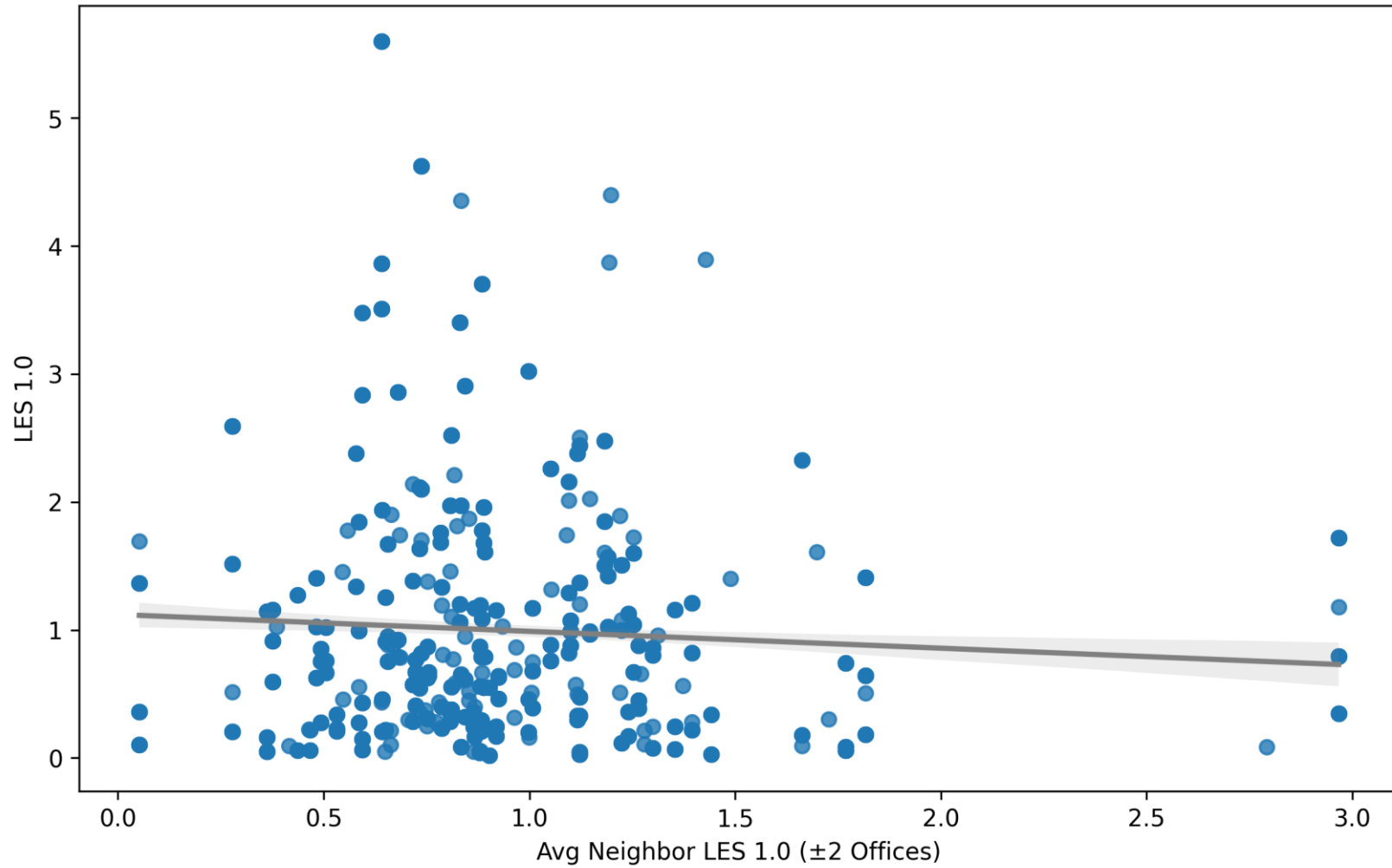


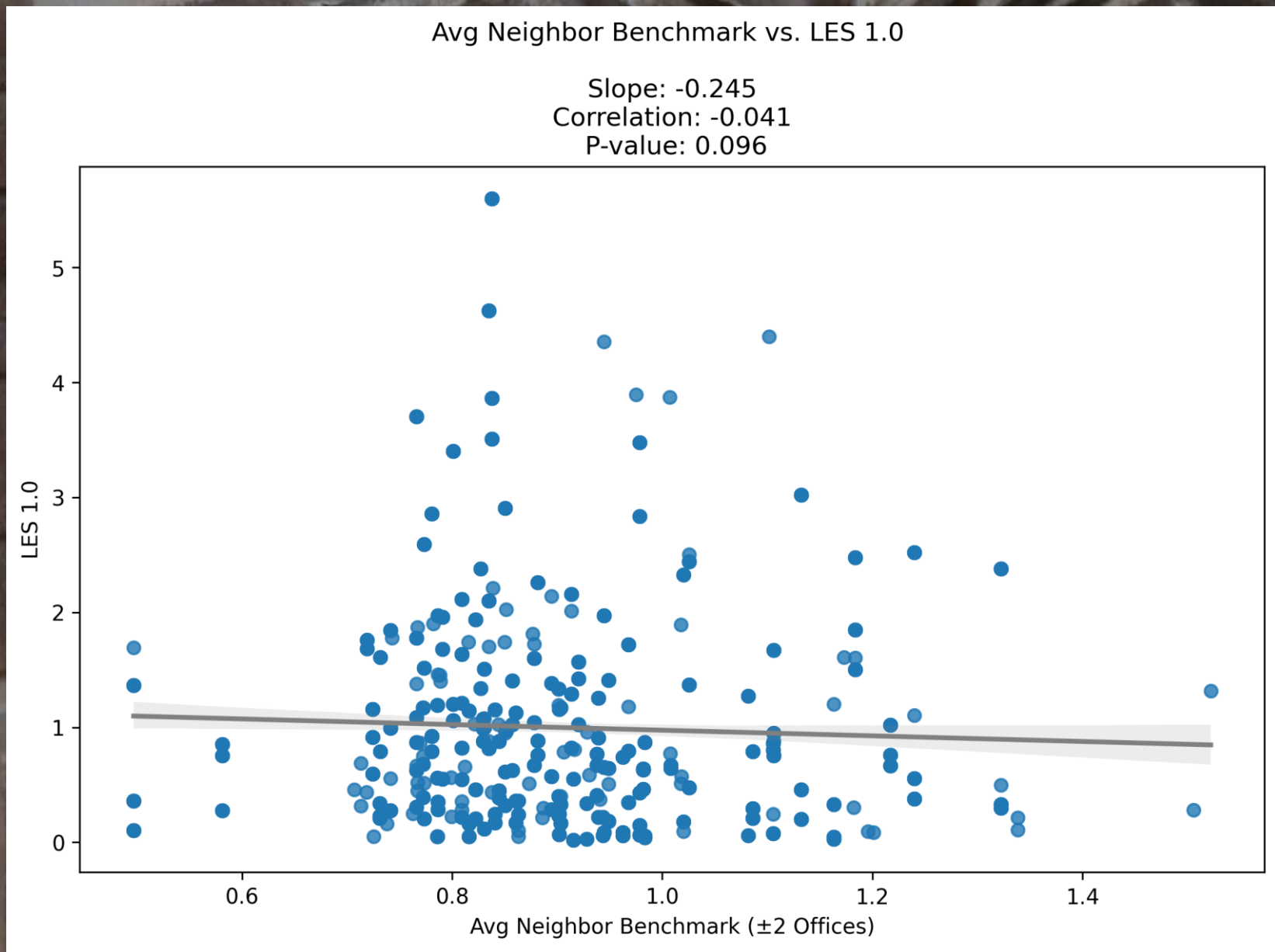




Average Neighbor LES 1.0 vs. LES 1.0

Slope: -0.132
Correlation: -0.132
P-Value: 0.012







Thank you!